

GJØVIK UNIVERSITY COLLEGE

BACHELOR THESIS

Snowman

A complete, effective and secure rule management system for SNORT®

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Preface

This is the preface.

Contents

Preface . . . . . **i**
Contents . . . . . **ii**
List of Figures . . . . . **iii**
List of Tables . . . . . **iv**
1 INTRODUCTION **1**
2 EXISTING SOLUTIONS **2**
3 REQUIREMENTS SPECIFICATION **3**
4 DESIGN **4**
5 IMPLEMENTATION **5**
5.1 Frameworks 5
5.2 Core module 5
5.3 Update module 5
5.3.1 Sources 5
5.3.2 Update types 5
5.3.3 Files 5
5.3.4 Running an update 5
5.3.5 Logging 7
5.4 Graphical User Interface 7
5.4.1 Structure 7
5.4.2 Design 7
5.4.3 Features 7
5.4.4 Rules/All rules page 8
6 OPTIMIZATION **9**
6.1 Update 9
7 TESTING **10**
8 RESULTS **11**
9 ANALYSIS OF RESULTS **12**
10 CONCLUSIONS **13**

List of Figures

1 GUI Structure 7
2 Rules/All rules page 8

List of Tables

1 Rule options used in this system. 6

1 INTRODUCTION

Følgende informasjon kan tas med her: - Organisering av rapporten og kort beskrivelse av sammenhengen mellom kapitlene. - Fullstendig definering av oppgaven med utdypning av hva oppgaven går ut på. Eksempelvis presiseres mål, problemområde, omfang og avgrensning. - Henvisning til eventuelle tidligere arbeider om samme emne. - Målgruppe for rapporten, jfr. mål- og mottakeranalysen. - Studentenes faglige bakgrunn. - Prosjektgruppens valgte arbeidsformer, f.eks. samtaler og intervjuer med kilder, reiser, bedriftsbesøk, litteraturstudier, laboratorieforsøk, modellbygging og testing. - Terminologibruk. Er eksempelvis faguttrykk brukt i en spesiell betydning? Innledningen skal ikke inneholde noe om det som er gjort i oppgaven og oppnådde resultater.

2 EXISTING SOLUTIONS

Her tenker jeg at vi tar med hva som fins av programvare fra før og peker påutfordringer i disse løesningene.

3 REQUIREMENTS SPECIFICATION

Med bistand fra oppdragsgiver skal det gjennomføres en analyse av hvilke krav som stilles til det nye systemet. Arbeidet skal resultere i et strukturert og godt kravspesifikasjonsdokument som definerer de funksjonelle og operasjonelle kravene til systemet. Dokumentet legges i sin helhet inn i prosjektrapporten under vedlegg. Det skal kort redegjøres for metodebruk og fremgangsmåte i arbeidet med å komme frem til spesifikasjonen.

4 DESIGN

Utfyllende med grunngitt valg av metoder, rammeverk etc. Hovedtrekk fra design av system beskrives. Fullstendig designdokument bør være vedlegg til prosjektrapporten, mens dette punktet omhandler diskusjon av sentrale forhold. Ulike alternative design som studentene vurderte bør beskrives og valg av alternativ begrunnes.

5 IMPLEMENTATION

This chapter will focus on the technical implementation of the software.

5.1 Frameworks

To simplify (db, web, code) this project uses the Django framework.

5.2 Core module

Lorem, ipsum?

5.3 Update module

The purpose of the Update module is to fetch and read rules and configuration files from external sources, and populate the database with this information. Effectiveness in updates is a key issue, and a number of deliberate optimizations for performing updates, with the goal of saving time by omitting unnecessary operations, are explained in the following sections.

The term Update is used to refer to the actual module, including all its classes and functions. To avoid confusion with the module, the term *update-package* is specifically used to refer to update data coming from external sources.

This section will define an example rule to be used throughout subsequent sections and the remainder of the chapter, to illustrate the lifespan of a rule in the system.

Word: rulestring.

5.3.1 Sources

5.3.2 Update types

An update is either performed manually or automatically. Any *Source* in the system can be configured with a time-interval for automatic updates.

5.3.3 Files

Rule files

A rule file is any file carrying the *.rules* file extension. These files contain raw rulestrings to be processed by Snort. A rulestring is basically a semicolon-separated list of rule options. There are several types of options, but only the general rule options are relevant for this project[1]. Specific rule options used in this system are listed in table 1.

A badly formatted rulestring given to Snort will cause a crash, and Snort must be restarted.

5.3.4 Running an update

As an example scenario, consider a rule (name, figure reference, source, ruleset etc.). An update is triggered on the source at the predefined time

The update is cancelled if the source is already up to date; the MD5-hashes of the latest update in the database, if any, and the latest update on the remote site are com-

[1] http://manual.snort.org/node30.html: "[General] options provide information about the rule but do not have any affect during detection".

Data field	Description	Presence
sid	Unique identifier for a rule.	required
rev	Rule revision number.	required
msg	Notification text when rule triggers.	required
classtype	Connects the rule with a specific class of attacks.	required
gid	Generator ID to identify which subsystem generates the event where this rule fires.	optional
ruleset	The ruleset this rule belongs to.	optional
reference	Reference to external resource with information about this attack.	optional

Note: Presence column indicates whether a field is required or not by the parser in this system. Information taken from *http://manual.snort.org/node31.html* .

Table 1: Rule options used in this system.

pared, and the process is terminated if these hashes are identical. Otherwise, the update is downloaded to a temporary directory and the update process continues. A file can be a tar-archive containing an arbitrary number of rulesets and configuration files, or it can be a plain text file containing Snort configuration (?).

The tar-archive is extracted, and the update module recursively parses each file in each folder. In most cases the update-package will contain only minor changes in relation to its predecessor, e.g. only one file is different in the latest package, and parsing all files that has not changed would therefore be a waste. To address this issue and save processing time, the name, path and MD5-hash of every file is stored in the database per source. Every time the update module parses a file, it first creates a hash of the file and compares this with the respective file's hash in the database. If the file is present in the database and the two hashes coincide, the file is considered *not new* and is skipped. The following sections will elaborate on the parsing of files based on file type.

parse files with regex.

Classification, Generator and Reference Type files

These files contain a sequence of their respective entities (section 5.3.3), and are all parsed in the same manner. If a given entity is not already present in the database, it is created and stored. If the database already contains the entity, the existing entry in the database is overwritten.

Rule files

If any properties classified as *required* for a rule (table 1)

A rule always belogs to a ruleset which can be specified in the raw rulestring. If the parser does not find this attribute in the rulestring, the filename is considered to be the ruleset name.

set rule properties.

Non-existing rule sets, rule classes and generators are stored in the database

After the initial parsing of the rulestring, the parser checks if the rule already exists in the database, and if so whether the incoming revision number is higher than the latest

revision of the pre-existing rule. The parsing will continue only in the event of a new rule or a newer revision of an existing rule.

rule moved to new ruleset.

Rule Message files

5.3.5 Logging

5.4 Graphical User Interface

The Graphical User Interface (GUI) is a template- and AJAX-based (desc/footnote?) Web application which uses Django's (desc) template system to implement the View part of the MVC-principle(ref). Each webpage is a template populated through Python-code before it is delivered to the Web server and ultimately the requesting Web browser.

Additional data that needs to be sent to a Web page, e.g. the user interacts with the GUI, is requested through JavaScript(desc) and AJAX-calls and then gets added to the already loaded DOM(desc) in the web browser.

5.4.1 Structure

The pages of the GUI is organized in the following structure:

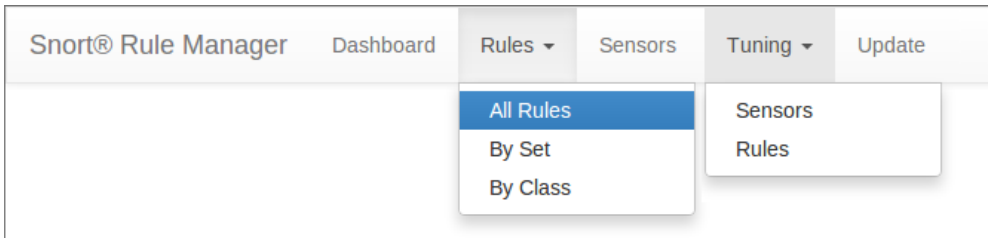


Figure 1: GUI Structure

5.4.2 Design

The GUI is designed with simplicity in mind, which is achieved by using a front-end framework called Bootstrap(ref). This framework provides easy-to-use and ready-made design elements for HTML and CSS(desc), which has been crucial for saving time and energy in the project. Consider the example job of creating a <table> element and spending hours setting up and tweaking the CSS for the said table element, we could just add <table class='**table table-bordered**'> and get the table formatted nicely with colors and fonts that are typographically matching.

5.4.3 Features

Content Prefetching

One of the main features of our GUI design is our usage of prefetching to speed up loading. Instead of loading absolutely everything into the web browsers DOM, like our predecessor BHTB did, we instead initially only load the first page or page elements. This significantly reduces loading times.

We then silently in the background load in any element the user might want to see next, through AJAX calls. When the user then interacts with the GUI, the next elements are shown to the user. The next-next elements are also loaded through AJAX calls so that they are ready.

This ensures that the user always has immidiate response from any interaction done

with the GUI, while keeping loading times to a bare minimum.

5.4.4 Rules/All rules page

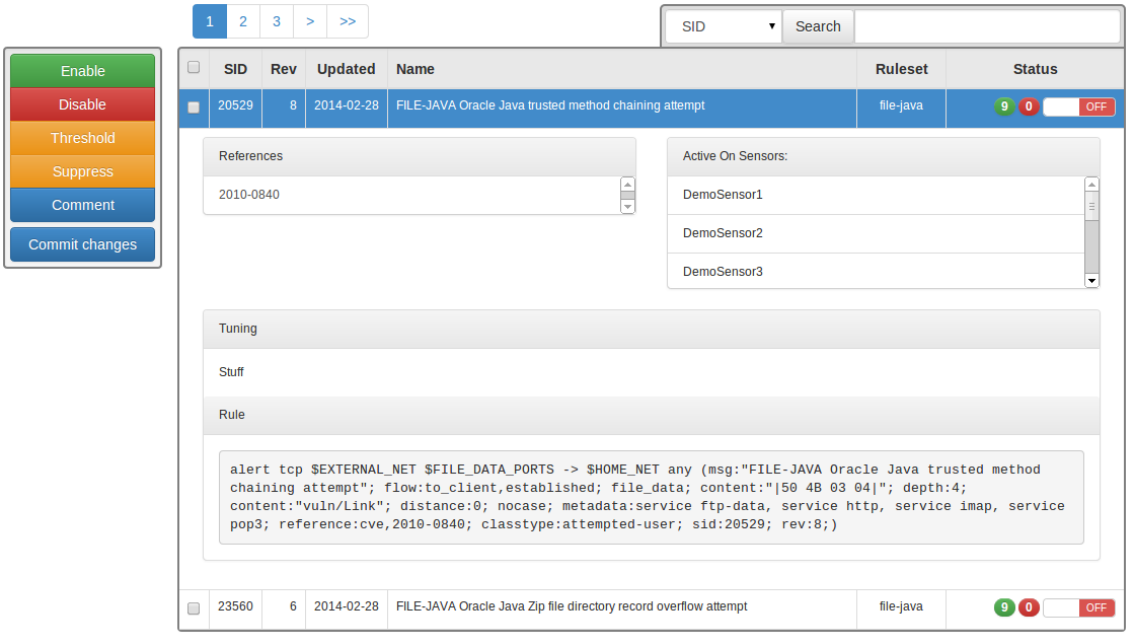


Figure 2: Rules/All rules page

This page serves as the complete list of all rules currently residing in the central database. Because the central database can literally contain hundreds of thousands of rules, this list is paginated. Pages are loaded using AJAX calls to prefetch them as needed.

Each row in the list can be clicked on, which expands an area containing additional information about the rule in question.

We anticipate that the main use of this page is to utilize the search function to find a specific rule or rules and then either retrieve information about them or tune them.

Rules can be tuned by checking the checkbox associated with the rule in question and then press the button that represent the desired function in the box to the left.

6 OPTIMIZATION

6.1 Update

7 TESTING

Tilstrekkelig beskrivelse til at forsøk og undersøkelser kan reproduseres og etterprøves: - Forsøksbetingelser, og hvordan disse stemmer med prinsipper beskrevet i kapittel 2. - Praktisk fremgangsmåte. - Analysemetode (oftest i vedlegg).

Her beskrives hvordan opplegget rundt testing av applikasjonen har vært. Dette omfatter planlegging, valg av teststrategier, gjennomføring av tester og beskrivelser av sentrale feil funnet under testing, samt måten feil ble rettet opp på.

8 RESULTS

De faktiske observasjoner og data fra forsøk (f.eks. målinger) og undersøkelser (f.eks. utspørringer) presenteres på en oversiktlig måte ved tabeller og/eller diagrammer. Bruk skjønn for evt. plassering i vedlegg. Ved bruk av diagrammer skal det gis beskrivende tekst til grafer. Resultatene skal kort kommenteres, men ikke diskuteres. Viktige resultater gjengis kortfattet under ”Sammendrag”. En oversikt over tabeller og diagrammer med nummer og titler kan plasseres etter innholdsfortegnelsen.

9 ANALYSIS OF RESULTS

Diskusjon rund resultatene. Det skal gjøres en evaluering av hvorvidtvalgt løsning. Avvik drøftes. det er samsvar mellom kravspesifikasjonen satt opp og

10 CONCLUSIONS

De slutninger som kan trekkes fra resultatene og deres diskusjon skal være logisk og nøkternt oppbygd. Etterrettelighet er vesentlig. Konklusjoner skal fremkomme klart og uten tvetydigheter. Eventuell usikkerhet påpekes. Grunnlaget for slik tvil skal redegjøres under kapittel 6a/6b. De viktigste konklusjoner blir presentert i kortfattet versjon under ”Sammendrag”. Prosjektgruppen bør ta stilling til hva de faglige resultatene kan brukes til, hva gruppen faglig har lært av dette arbeidet, hva som evt. kunne vært gjort annerledes ved en gjentagelse av utviklingsarbeidet, og hvordan eventuelt videre arbeid rundt samme eller beslektet tema bør gjøres. Gruppen bør også kommentere den subjektive opplevelse av hovedprosjektet, og hvordan gruppeprosessen har vært. Kort sagt: Egenevaluering av gruppearbeidet.